[112] *Swadesamitran*, 18-10-1909. Bharati too urged other entertainment companies to emulate these examples, *India*, 16-10-1909. The CID police reported a figure of 'about Rs 600' adding that the company was managed by M.D. Gopala Rao and K.A. Vaidyanatha Aiyar, MPAI, 1909, para 1191(b).

[113] *Bande Mataram*, 27-3-1908.

[114] See Venkatachalapathy, ed., *Va.Oo.Chiyum Bharatiyum* for a comprehensive collection of Bharati's writings on VOC.

[115] *India*, 30-1-1909. MPAI, 1909, para 238(a) provides a full English translation of this appeal; it was also printed separately and circulated in Pondicherry.

[116] *India*, 2-10-1909, editorial.

[117] *India*, 30-1-1909.

[118] Ibid.

[119] *India*, 6-2-1909. Endorsing Bharati's comments that the rich squandered money on courtesans and wasteful litigation, Ramaiyer further likened VOC to Bhagiratha. Later in the year, this Ramaiyer sold the donation tickets issued by the company and remitted Rs 16 (*India*, 2-10-1909).

[120] *India*, 13-2-1909.

[121] Ibid.

[122] This was an argument adduced often by the Swadeshi partisans. For instance, an appeal issued by SSNCo in December 1908, argued: 'The Company has no doubt worked in the past at a loss, but this was nothing compared to the *great gain made by our country in general*. A very large sum of money, decidedly much more than the capital of twenty lacs of rupees that our Company now asks for, has *already* been saved by Indian passengers and shippers on account of the reduction of rates.' (*The Hindu*, 28-12-1908. Emphasis in original.) VOC himself employed this logic: speaking at a public meeting during the anti-Rowlatt agitation in March 1919, he said: 'Even though [SSNCo] collapsed the nation did not suffer any loss. Through undercutting of rates, SSNCo suffered a loss of 15 lakh rupees. But this money did not leave our shores. The rival BI too undercut and suffered a loss of 95 lakh rupees. This too did not leave our country. Therefore, even though our company collapsed India as a whole